Class Malacostraca *continued*

SQUAT LOBSTERS
Squat lobsters (superfamily Galatheoidae) are relatively slow movers but most species use their abdomen to swim rapidly backward to escape predators. Many species are mainly nocturnal and hide under rocks and in cracks during the day. Shown here is the blue-striped squat lobster, Galathea strigosa, *from European shallow seas.*

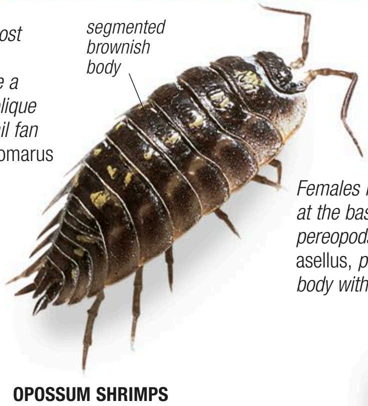
HERMIT CRABS
The most characteristic feature of hermit crabs (superfamily Paguroidea) is that they carry the shells of gastropods around as homes, changing an old shell for a bigger one as they grow. The white-spotted hermit crab, Dardanus megistos, *shown above, inhabits the lower shores of sandy and rocky, Northern and Western European coasts.*

LAND HERMIT CRABS
Like hermit crabs, land hermit crabs (family Coenobitidae) also carry shells around. An exception is the coconut or robber crab, Birgus latro, *pictured fighting above, which does not have a shell. It is the heaviest terrestrial crustacean, with a weight of up to 8¾ lb (4 kg). It lives in the tropics, and feeds mainly on the fruit of coconut palms. A good climber, its slow speed means it is easy to hunt and is becoming rare in some places.*

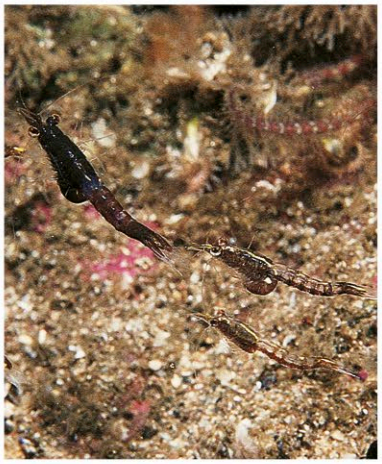
CRAYFISH
Members of the family Astacidae, freshwater crayfish resemble small lobsters. The first 3 pairs of legs have claws, the front pair being the largest. They make burrows in silt or mud where they hide during the day. The white-clawed crayfish, Austropotamobius pallipes, *shown above, inhabits well-aerated streams in southwest Europe.*

LOBSTERS
The family Nephropidae includes the largest and most commercially important crustaceans, the lobsters. Measuring up to 3¼ ft (1 m) in length, lobsters have a roughly cylindrical carapace with transverse and oblique grooves. The abdomen is elongated with a broad tail fan for rapid backward escape. The common lobster, Homarus gammarus, *shown above, has a blue upper and a yellowish lower surface. Using its large claws, it cracks open mollusks and feeds on them at night.*

PILL WOODLICE
Pill woodlice or pillbugs (family Armadillidiidae) have the ability to roll into a tight ball for protection. They have a rounded back as well as a rounded hind margin. Usually terrestrial, they have 2 pairs of lunglike organs (pseudotracheae) on the abdominal appendages for breathing air. As in many woodlice, the newly hatched young have one pair of legs fewer than they will have as adults. Pictured here is the common pill woodlouse, Armadillidium vulgare.

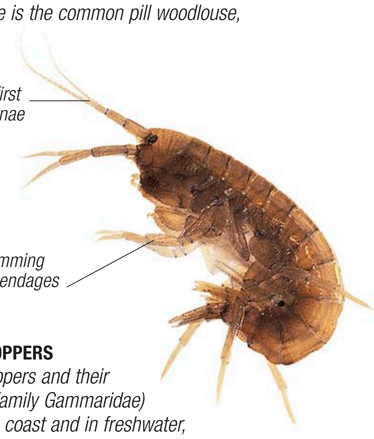


ONISCID WOODLICE
Most oniscid woodlice (family Oniscidae) are terrestrial, living in damp microhabitats, such as rotting wood, under stones, and in caves. They have a flattened body with clear segmentation and no carapace. Females have a brood pouch formed from plates at the bases of the first five pairs of walking legs, or pereopods. The common shiny woodlouse, Oniscus asellus, *pictured left, has a shiny, mottled grayish body with 2 rows of pale patches.*



OPOSSUM SHRIMPS
Shrimps of the family Mysidae, have distinctive movement sensors at the base of the inner pair of flaplike appendages on either side of the tail fan. Most of them live worldwide in estuarine or marine waters (from the coast to the deep sea), and are free swimmers. Elongated and soft bodied, many are pale or translucent but deep-sea species are red. Many form schools and are important food for both fishes and humans.

SKELETON SHRIMPS
Skeleton shrimps (family Caprellidae) do not swim, and instead cling to seaweed, catching food that drifts within reach. Their bodies are extremely slender, with a long thorax and a tiny abdomen. The specimen shown here belongs to the genus Caprella, *which, with over 140 species, is the largest in the family. Close relatives of these animals live on whales and dolphins.*



BEACH-HOPPERS
Beach-hoppers and their relatives (family Gammaridae) live on the coast and in freshwater, often among rotting vegetation. Most species—like this one from Europe—have a curved abdomen that can flick the animal away from danger.